

Strike

Lightning always takes the quickest path to the ground. So tall trees and buildings are most likely to be struck. The world's tallest buildings are struck by lightning hundreds of times each year.

Each fork of lightning is many lightning flashes running rapidly up and down the same path.

You can figure out how far away a storm is by counting the seconds between a flash of lightning and a thunderclap. For every three seconds you count, the storm is half a mile (1 km) away.



Holy thunder

Some Native Americans believed that the sacred thunderbird made thunder by beating its enormous wings, and that lightning flashed from its beak.